

PRINCIPLES

1. Always use the "Rule of the Square" to determine if your pawn can promote before the enemy king can catch it.
2. Identify and control key squares to enhance your pawn's promotion chances.
3. Bring your king closer to the pawn to support its advance.
4. Use opposition to restrict the movement of the enemy king.
5. Avoid pushing your pawn too early; ensure your king is in a favorable position first.
6. Understand how to promote doubled pawns effectively against a king.
7. In king and pawn versus king endgames, always aim to keep your king in front of the pawn.
8. Calculate potential pawn promotions carefully before making moves.
9. Use shouldering techniques to block the opposing king's path.
10. Familiarize yourself with basic winning and drawing techniques in pawn endgames.

SITUATION

Here, the pawn has advanced to the 6th rank, and the black king is trying to block its path. The white king is positioned to support the pawn's advance. The key concept is that the pawn can only promote with the help of the king, and the white king must prevent the black king from standing in front of the pawn. This lesson emphasizes the importance of opposition and blocking techniques in pawn endings.

FEN: 8/5k2/8/4P3/4K3/8/8/8 w - - 0 1

GOAL

White's objective is to promote the pawn with the support of the king, while Black's goal is to block

the pawn's advance and capture it.

STRATEGY

Control key squares to ensure the pawn can promote. The white king must be positioned to block the black king's path while supporting the pawn's advance. This involves understanding opposition and blocking techniques.

MOVES

First, move your king to c7 to prevent the black king from reaching the pawn's path. If they respond with Ke6, you can advance the pawn. The most accurate move order would be: 1. Kc7 Ke6 2. b4 Kd5 3. b5 1-0

HOW IT LINKS TO THE RULES

This lesson illustrates the importance of controlling key squares and using opposition to support the pawn's advance. It also highlights the need to block the enemy king's path effectively.